FlexFit Studio: Sync Class Owner to Trainer's User

Salesforce Administrator portfolio project: record-triggered Flow, Phase 3 (Automation)

Overview

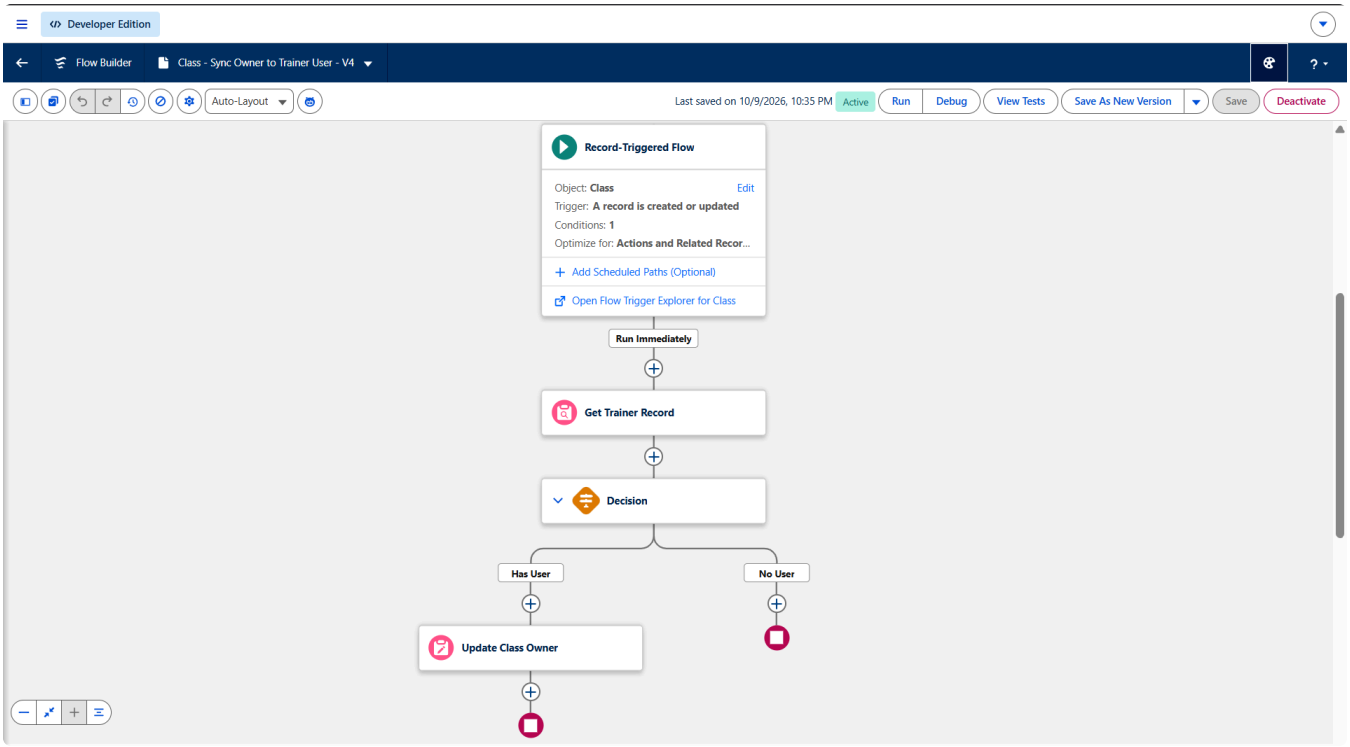
FlexFit Studio is a fictional gym management org I built in a Salesforce Developer Edition org. It models members, trainers, classes, membership plans, and class enrollments. This write-up covers a record-triggered Flow that automatically assigns each Class's Owner to the trainer teaching it, so record access follows the data instead of being managed by hand.

The Business Problem

Trainers should be able to edit their own classes but only view other trainers' classes. The Class object had a plain Trainer lookup field, and Salesforce ownership-based sharing rules only work off the record's Owner field. Nothing connected "this class belongs to Trainer X" to the Owner, so access could not be granted dynamically.

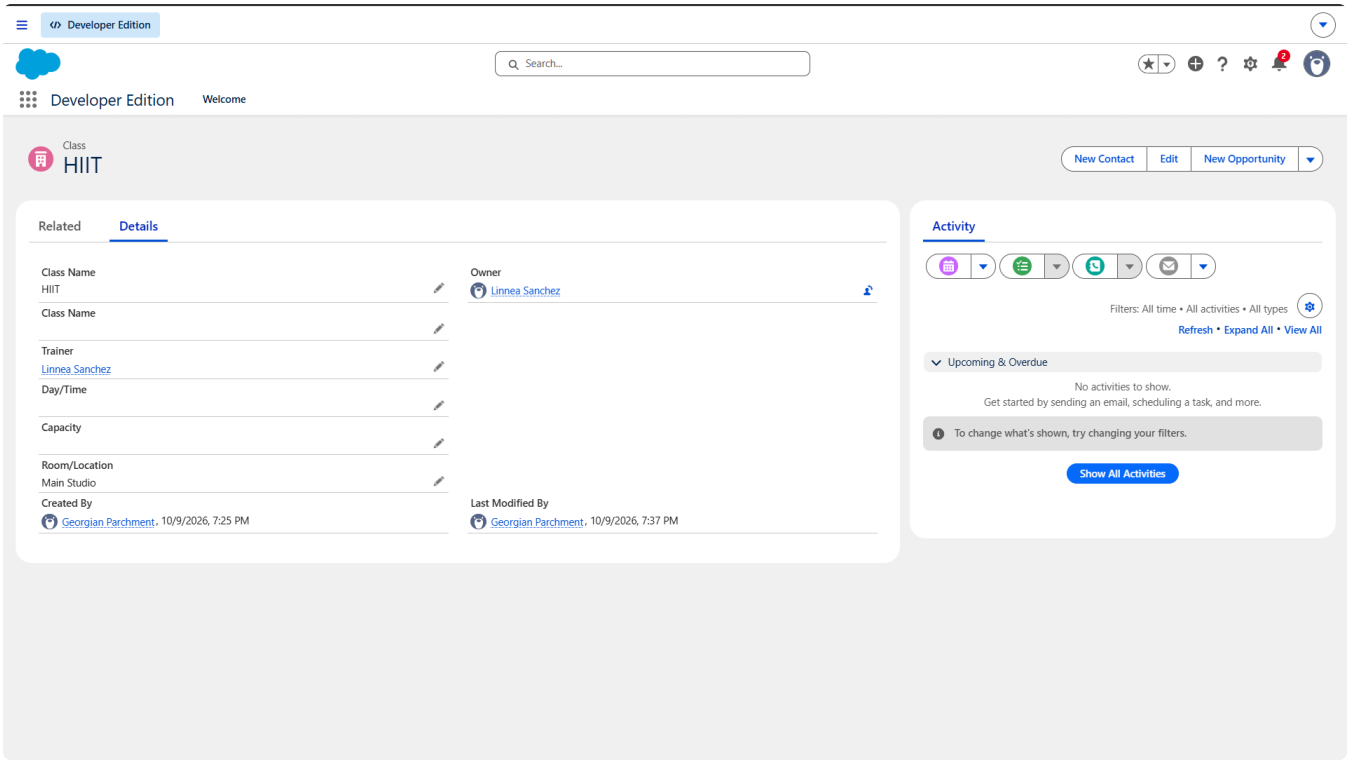
The Solution

1. **Linked trainers to real users.** I added a Trainer User lookup (to User) on the Trainer object, so each Trainer record points to a Salesforce user.
2. **Built a record-triggered Flow on Class.**
   - Trigger: a Class is created or updated, with the entry condition that the Trainer field is changed
   - Optimized for Actions and Related Records
3. **Get Records (Trainer).** Finds the Trainer record whose Record ID matches the Class's Trainer.
4. **Decision (null check).** Continues only if the Trainer has a linked user, so a Class can still be saved when no user is linked.
5. **Update Records (Class).** Sets the Class's Owner ID to the Trainer's linked user.



Result

Assigning a Trainer to a Class now sets the Owner automatically. This makes ownership-based sharing possible: the Class org-wide default can be tightened to Public Read Only, and trainers get edit access to their own classes through a sharing rule (principle of least privilege).



Troubleshooting Notes

My first version failed on save with an "owner cannot be blank" error. Using Flow Debug, I found two problems:

- **Wrong filter value.** The Get Records filter compared a Trainer ID against the Trainer's linked User ID, so no Trainer record was ever found. I fixed it by filtering on the Class's own Trainer field.
- **Editing the active version.** My earlier fixes were not applying because Salesforce does not let you overwrite an active flow version. I had to use Save As New Version and reactivate.

Takeaways: read the debug log before guessing, treat active flows as read-only, and always plan for missing data (the Decision element).

Skills Demonstrated

- Record-triggered Flow design (entry conditions, Get Records, Decision, Update Records)
- Flow debugging and versioning
- Data model design (Lookup versus Master-Detail, junction objects)

- Security model thinking: org-wide defaults, ownership-based sharing, least privilege
- Handling null and missing data in automation

Next Steps

- Tighten the Class org-wide default to Public Read Only
- Build the ownership-based sharing rule for trainers
- Add a short Loom walkthrough of the Flow and the working result